

KEY POINTS

- Hurricane Melissa affected more than 5 million people across Jamaica, Cuba, and Haiti, killing at least 75 people and displacing or forcing the evacuation of over 770,000.
- In Jamaica, more than 4.8 million tonnes of debris continue to block roads and public spaces, while around 30 communities remain cut off, hampering relief and recovery operations.
- In Cuba, the UN System launched a US\$74 million Plan of Action to assist one million people across four eastern provinces.
- In Haiti, the UN and partners are scaling up operations in the Grand Sud region, where 43 deaths have been confirmed and over 1,700 people remain displaced across 10 shelters.



Westmoreland Parish, Jamaica. Photo: OCHA/Marc Belanger

SITUATION OVERVIEW

Hurricane Melissa struck western Jamaica on 28 October and moved across eastern Cuba the following day, affecting more than 5 million people across Jamaica, Cuba, and Haiti. The storm killed at least 75 people, displaced or forced the evacuation of over 778,000, and destroyed tens of thousands of homes, schools, and other buildings.

In the three countries, some communities remain cut off, with access and logistics constraints slowing assessments and the delivery of life-saving aid.

JAMAICA

- Hurricane Melissa devastated Jamaica, striking key economic and population centres and affecting close to 1.6 million people. The western and southern parishes remain hardest hit, littered with debris, blocked access routes, and interrupted essential services. According to UNDP, over 4.8 million tonnes of debris—about 480,000 truckloads—clog roads, schools, and public spaces.
- Access and logistics constraints continue to hamper the scale-up of operations, particularly in western Jamaica. At least 30 communities remain cut off by damaged or obstructed roads, while unstable slopes continue to trigger landslides and flash floods.
- Relief agencies report urgent needs for safe water, fuel for health facilities, food, shelter materials, and psychosocial support. Health services remain overstretched, with many facilities still relying on generators and temporary supply networks.
- All secondary hospitals are operating in emergency-only mode, focusing on critical and urgent cases. Five major hospitals sustained severe damage, including the inoperable Black River Hospital. With over 3,000 hospital beds affected and several facilities running beyond capacity, maintaining essential health services for vulnerable groups—

especially children and pregnant women—remains a priority. PAHO indicated that damage to water and sanitation systems, prolonged power outages, stagnant water, and population displacement have created conditions for the spread of vector-borne, respiratory, food-, and water-borne diseases.

- Shelter loss in Montego Bay is substantial: Preliminary assessments indicate that up to 5,200 people in Montego Bay alone may have lost roofs or have severe housing damage. IOM indicates that current shelter assistance remains insufficient compared to needs, particularly in hard-hit parishes.
- The Government estimates losses of between US\$6 and 7 billion, equivalent to 28–32 per cent of Jamaica’s 2024/25 GDP. The storm severely hit the agriculture and tourism sectors, destroying crops and livestock in St. Elizabeth, Manchester, and Westmoreland, and forcing the temporary closure of major resorts. Housing damage is extensive, with more than 120,000 buildings affected, many classified as severely or catastrophically damaged.

CUBA

- More than a week after Hurricane Melissa struck eastern Cuba, the full extent of the devastation continues to unfold, particularly in the provinces of Santiago de Cuba and Granma, the hardest hit by the storm. As assessments advance, the number of damaged homes, schools, health institutions, and agricultural areas continues to rise.
- More than 54,000 people remain evacuated, including 7,500 housed in state shelters. Authorities report that 1.3 million people were protected before the hurricane’s landfall through large-scale preventive evacuations. Across the affected provinces, over 76,700 homes sustained damage—mostly to roofs—while 642 healthcare institutions and 2,117 schools have been impacted. In the education sector, 41 per cent of schools in affected provinces suffered some level of damage, with Santiago de Cuba and Holguín recording the highest numbers.
- Agricultural losses now exceed 103,000 hectares, with severe damage to grains, cassava, plantains, and coffee crops. In some mountainous areas, flooding continues to hamper damage verification. Infrastructure collapse, blocked access routes, and flooding still isolate dozens of communities, particularly in rural zones, complicating relief delivery and recovery.

HAITI

- Haiti is still dealing with the severe humanitarian consequences of Hurricane Melissa, which brought torrential rain, flooding, landslides and dangerous sea conditions to the southern peninsula and parts of the Ouest department. The Sud, Grand’Anse, Nippes and Ouest regions have been hit hardest, with widespread damage to homes, infrastructure, bridges and community water systems.
- Government reports indicate that more than 1,500 people are still in temporary shelters as of 4 November, with at least 43 fatalities confirmed and several people still missing while search and verification efforts continue. Earlier in the week, flooding and heavy rainfall temporarily isolated multiple communities, and damage to health facilities, water networks, and electricity systems is further complicating response operations. In Grand’Anse, several communal sections remain isolated, complicating humanitarian access.

RESPONSE

REGIONAL

The United Nations and partners are supporting Government-led response efforts in the three countries. In Jamaica, Rapid Needs Assessment Teams—including those from the United States (DART), the United Kingdom (FCDO), CDEMA regional teams, and several international NGOs—are working alongside national authorities to assess needs and coordinate the response. OCHA is providing support for coordination and information management, helping to ensure consistent information flows among partners and effective planning across sectors.

JAMAICA

- The Government of Jamaica, supported by humanitarian and development partners, continues to lead the national response, prioritizing access restoration, life-saving assistance, and early recovery. Prime Minister Andrew Holness announced recovery measures including targeted rebuilding support by parish, a six-month mortgage moratorium for affected homeowners, and tax and customs exemptions for relief items such as solar panels and satellite internet kits.
- The United Nations, supported by a UN Disaster Assessment and Coordination (UNDAC) team of 16 members, is coordinating relief efforts with the Government of Jamaica and partners. More than 60 organizations, including authorities, donors, NGOs, UN agencies, and the private sector, have joined the OCHA-led coordination system to register assistance, offers, and deliveries.
- To strengthen medical capacity, Samaritan's Purse has deployed an emergency field hospital at Black River High School in St. Elizabeth, replacing the destroyed Black River Hospital. The facility is staffed by 60 personnel and includes a pharmacy, laboratory, and operating room, serving as the main medical center for the parish until permanent infrastructure is restored.
- The Pan-American Health Organization (PAHO) has delivered over 5.5 tons of medical supplies and trauma kits and deployed 12 technical experts in health services, WASH, coordination, logistics, environmental health, and mental health to support care continuity and disease surveillance. On 4 November, they launched a [Donor Alert](#) seeking US\$14.2 million in support for its response operations.
- The World Food Programme (WFP) and partners are working to stabilize supply chains through the Logistics Control Tower, reopening key corridors and exploring alternate delivery routes via the Dominican Republic. The Government has announced the establishment of 22 humanitarian hubs, led by the Jamaica Defence Force (JDF), to coordinate relief operations and improve delivery to hard-hit areas.
- Two international naval vessels have also arrived to reinforce logistics operations — a French ship carrying water-treatment units and emergency shelter materials, and the Dutch naval support ship HNLMS *Pelikaan* with over 600 m³ of WASH, shelter, and medical supplies.
- On 4 November, the International Organization for Migration (IOM) launched a [Flash Appeal](#) of US\$17.2 million to support the response for the period November 2025 to April 2026. The appeal aims to assist 96,000 people—including 48,000 women and 14,000 persons with disabilities—across the four hardest-hit parishes of Westmoreland, Hanover, Saint James, and Trelawny, where 468,000 people, or 92 per cent of the population, were severely affected.
- A private-sector liaison officer is deloying from the OCHA/Connecting Business Initiative to facilitate connections between international, regional and national private-sector partners, and to support the strengthening of coordination with the Private Sector Organisation of Jamaica (PSOJ), the Jamaica Chamber of Commerce and the Jamaica Manufacturers' Association (JMA).
- The Caribbean Catastrophe Risk Insurance Facility (CCRIF SPC) has disbursed US\$92 million to the Government under its parametric insurance policies, providing critical liquidity for early response and recovery efforts.
- More in the latest Situation Report: <https://reliefweb.int/node/4185872>

CUBA

- The Government of Cuba continues to lead emergency operations, focusing on reaching isolated communities, restoring essential services, and providing food, water, and health assistance to the most affected populations. Water and sanitation restoration remains a top priority, with pumping units repaired and deployed to ensure safe water access. Progress has been made in restoring electricity and water networks—up to 80 per cent service restoration in some provinces—though significant gaps remain in Granma and Santiago de Cuba.
- The United Nations System in Cuba, under the leadership of the Resident Coordinator, is supporting the national response and conducting joint field missions with Government officials and partners. Humanitarian assistance already mobilized to affected areas continues to be distributed, addressing immediate needs in WASH, shelter, food, and health.
 - UNICEF has delivered 29 new water tanks (236 m³ capacity) and 69,000 water purification tablet packages, benefiting up to 16,000 people daily. Three additional water purification plants for Granma will provide safe drinking water for 21,000 people.

- UNDP is providing 6,000 metal roofing sheets, 3,900 tarpaulins, toolkits, and generators to support recovery in Granma and Guantánamo.
- UNFPA has supplied sexual and reproductive health kits, contraceptives, and clinical management materials for gender-based violence cases.
- PAHO/WHO is delivering medical equipment, fumigation kits, and generators to reinforce health services and vector control in affected provinces.
- WFP has reached 140,000 people with food distributions in protection centers and communal kitchens in Granma, Santiago de Cuba, Guantánamo, and Holguín.
- FAO has mobilized agricultural seeds, feed, irrigation systems, roofing materials, and fishing supplies to help restore livelihoods.
- On 5 November, the United Nations System in Cuba, together with the Government, has launched a [Plan of Action](#) to support the national response to the devastating impact of Hurricane Melissa. The plan aims to assist one million people among the 2.2 million in need across the eastern provinces of Granma, Santiago de Cuba, Holguín, and Guantánamo, outlining a coordinated response by UN agencies in support of the Government and the Civil Defense System. It calls for US\$74 million, of which US\$4 million was released ahead of the hurricane from the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) under its Anticipatory Action programme, and another US\$7 million has been contributed from UN agencies' own resources—leaving a funding gap of about US\$64 million to meet urgent needs. The response focuses on health, water and sanitation, shelter, education, and early recovery, with special attention to the needs of women, children, and other vulnerable groups.
- More in the latest Situation Report: <https://reliefweb.int/node/4185875>

HAITI

- The United Nations and humanitarian partners continue to support Government-led operations, scaling up response efforts in the Grand Sud region, the area most affected by Hurricane Melissa.
- Since 24 October, the IOM Common Pipeline has provided partners with around 3,100 shelter kits (tarpaulins and fixing kits) and continues to monitor the situation with ongoing evaluations. IOM reached 2,974 families with cash assistance (around US\$192) as part of its anticipatory action interventions.
- The United Nations Humanitarian Air Service (UNHAS) has scaled up its operations and opened five new access points to facilitate the delivery of aid to the hardest-hit areas.

More in the latest Situation Reports: <https://bit.ly/3JpDDnD>

Previous Flash Updates are available at: <https://bit.ly/4qy8rmN>

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For more information, please visit [ReliefWeb](https://reliefweb.int/latin-america-and-caribbean/hurricane-melissa) | For operational updates: [response.reliefweb.int/latin-america-and-caribbean/hurricane-melissa](https://reliefweb.int/latin-america-and-caribbean/hurricane-melissa)
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